

Notes on George Perec: Eco (1994).

Narrativity and illusion of understanding: Wilson, Gilbert, and Centerbar (2003): “Helplessness theory has demonstrated that if people feel that they cannot control or predict their environments, they are at risk for severe motivational and cognitive deficits, such as depression.” For the writing down of a diary, see Wilson (2002) or Wegner (2002).

E. M. Forster’s example: reference in Margalit (2002).

National character: Terracciano et al. (2005) and Robins (2005) for the extent of individual variations. The illusion of nationality trait, which I usually call the “nationality heuristic,” does connect to the halo effect: see Rosenzweig (2006) and Cialdini (2001). See Anderson (1983) for the ontology of nationality.

Consistency bias: What psychologists call the consistency bias is the effect of revising memories in such a way to make sense with respect to subsequent information. See Schacter (2001).

Memory not like storage on a computer: Rose (2003), Nader and LeDoux (1999).

The myth of repressed memory: Loftus and Ketcham (2004).

Chess players and disconfirmation: Cowley and Byrne (2004).

Quine’s problem: Davidson (1983) argues in favor of local, but against total, skepticism.

Narrativity: Note that my discussion is not existential here, but merely practical, so my idea is to look at narrativity as an informational compression, nothing more involved philosophically (like whether a self is sequential or not). There is a literature on the “narrative self”—Bruner (2002) or whether it is necessary—see Strawson (1994) and his attack in Strawson (2004). The debate: Schechtman (1997), Taylor (1999), Phelan (2005). Synthesis in Turner (1996).

“Postmodernists” and the desirability of narratives: See McCloskey (1990) and Frankfurter and McGoun (1996).

Narrativity of sayings and proverbs: Psychologists have long examined the gullibility of people in social settings when faced with well-sounding proverbs. For instance, experiments have been made since the 1960s where people are asked whether they believe that a proverb is right, while another cohort is presented with the opposite meaning. For a presentation of the hilarious results, see Myers (2002).